

What about the hardware specifications of the PS4 Pro?

This is what we know about the specifications of the PS4 Pro:

Main processor: Custom-chip single Processor

CPU: x86-64 AMD "Jaguar," 8 cores

GPU: 4.20 TFLOPS, AMD Radeon based graphics engine

Memory: GDDR5 8GB

Storage size: 1TB

External dimensions: Approx. 295×55×327 mm (width × height × length) (excludes largest projection)

Mass: Approx. 3.3 kg

BD/DVD Drive: BD × 6 CAV, DVD × 8 CAV

Input/Output: Super-Speed USB (USB 3.1 Gen.1) port × 3, AUX port × 1

Networking: Ethernet (10BASE-T, 100BASE-TX, 1000BASE-T)×1, IEEE 802.11 a/b/g/n/ac, Bluetooth® 4.0 (LE)

Power: AC 100V, 50/60Hz

Power consumption: Max. 310W

Operating temp: 5°C – 35°C

AV Output: HDMI out port (supports 4K/HDR) DIGITAL OUT (OPTICAL) port

PS: 4.2 Teraflops is less than what Microsoft claims Project Scorpio can do (6 Teraflops)

Will all games be in 4K HDR?

It's a developer decision. All games will not necessarily be in 4K HDR. All the upcoming games will run on both the PS4 and the PS4 Pro, and all games will be forward compatible is what Sony has said. This means that all PS4 games will work on the Pro, even if the game doesn't support 4K or HDR.

Does it make sense for me to buy the Pro, even if I own a 1080p gaming monitor/1080p TV?

Technically, yes. It makes sense to buy the Pro if you want better graphical fidelity. Sony explained this with the following example: On Shadow of Mordor running with SSAA (Super Sampling Anti Aliasing), the image is rendered in a resolution higher than 1080p, and represented to the gamer in 1080p. This is just one example, and we will of course give you more information about the gaming fidelity once we get our hands on the console.

To quote the PlayStation Blog, "However, even if you own an HDTV that does not support either 4K or HDR, PS4 Pro still provides a number of benefits. All games will run in 1080p resolution, and some will even run in a higher or more stable framerate. If you're a gamer that wants to be at the forefront of innovation, PS4 Pro is for you." This simply means that games will run better on the PS4 Pro, when compared to the original PS4. A piece of advice: If you can afford it, go for the newer hardware.

What about PlayStation VR?

Well, the PS VR will work with both the PS4 and PS4 Pro. Just to give you an example of the difference that gamers will face, Sony spoke of an upcoming PlayStation VR game, Farpaint. The game will get better graphics and will perform better, thanks to the power of the PS4 Pro. With VR games, the fidelity and overall VR performance will also be better on the Pro, thanks to the hardware.

Can I watch 4K Blu Ray on the PS4 Pro?

No. The system doesn't support it. But you can watch 4K HDR content from Netflix and YouTube. It's a little disappointing that the Pro doesn't support 4K Blu Ray, especially when you consider Sony's console history. The PS1 played audio CDs, the PS2 had a built-in DVD player, the PS3 was one of the least expensive Blu Ray players, and the PS4 can play 1080p Blu Ray movies. So, exactly why Sony chose to break away from this tradition is bewildering. The only logical explanation is to keep the cost of the console low.

Still confused? Okay, this should help

■ Xbox One = Xbox Exclusive games + a healthy library of third party games

■ Xbox One S = Above + 4K Blu Ray playback + 4K HDR Streaming + HDR gaming

■ PS4 = PlayStation Exclusive games + a healthy library of third party games + HDR video (coming via

software update) + PlayStation VR (sold separately)

■ PS4 Pro = Above + 4K HDR gaming and 4K HDR video playback via streaming only (no 4K HDR Blu Ray support)

Xbox One S vs. Project Scorpio vs. PS4 vs. PS4 Pro

Still with us? Damn, you really are contemplating purchasing one of these machines! So here's the deal; if you are looking to pick up a console today, look for a good deal. The PS4 and Xbox One are still priced upwards of ₹30,000 in India, which is just unfair. If you can get your hands on one from abroad, then go for it, both are great consoles. Your purchase decision should primarily be based on the games you enjoy. If you like Halo and Forza, then go for the Xbox One. Just remember, the power brick will need an adapter to work in India (the voltage is different).

If you can get your hands on the Xbox One S, you will get HDR gaming, which isn't there on the PS4, along with the ability to watch 4K Blu Rays, another feature missing from the PS4.

If you like games like Uncharted and God of War, then go for a PS4. Whether you get the Slim variant or the original version doesn't matter, since apart from the aesthetics, nothing has changed as far as performance is concerned.

Microsoft teased the Xbox Project Scorpio at E3 2016, with more details to come in 2017. Sony has tried to cash in with the first movers' advantage, and the Pro will be available in November 2016. If you are as impatient as me and want the latest and greatest of the gaming world, then go get the Pro. It'll be a good device to own, especially if you don't own a PS4 and are considering upgrading. The smart move, however, would be to wait for a library of games to launch that take advantage of the Pro's capabilities before buying it. If you wait till Microsoft announces the Scorpio, chances are that you may get the PS4 Pro for a much cheaper, internationally. However, a true PS Pro vs. Scorpio comparison can be made only when Microsoft gives us some concrete information.*